

CRITICAL: Name Disambiguation & Listing Uniqueness Rules

Flag #1: Sylvia's Restaurant / NYC Status

In your verification response, you referenced "Sylvia's Restaurant" in the context of Philadelphia visibility. Sylvia's Restaurant is located in Harlem, NYC — NOT Philadelphia. NYC has not launched yet, so Sylvia's should be `staged`, not `live_unclaimed`. Please confirm:

1. Sylvia's Restaurant is correctly tagged to New York City (not Philadelphia)
2. Its `listing_status` is `staged` (since NYC hasn't launched)
3. No NYC businesses were accidentally promoted to `live_unclaimed`

Run a quick query: `SELECT name, city, listing_status FROM tour_guide_businesses WHERE city LIKE '%New York%' OR city LIKE '%NYC%' LIMIT 10` — confirm all are `staged`.

Flag #2: Name Disambiguation — The Core Problem

There are businesses across the country (and within the SAME city) that share identical or similar names. The system MUST handle this correctly. Two real-world scenarios:

Scenario A: Same Name, Same City, Different Businesses

Example: There are at least 4 hair salons in Philadelphia with "Allure" in their name. They are:

- Different owners
- Different addresses
- Different services
- All REAL, all deserve their own pin

The system CANNOT:

- Collapse them into one listing
- Assume they're duplicates
- Merge their reviews
- Show only one and hide the others

Scenario B: Similar Name, Completely Different Business Type

Example: "Apollo Pizza" (a pizza shop) vs. "Apollo Theater" (a historic cultural landmark in Harlem). Even if they're on the same block, they are COMPLETELY unrelated.

The system CANNOT:

- Link them because they share "Apollo" in the name
- Show Apollo Pizza's reviews on the Apollo Theater's card
- Suggest one when a user searches for the other (unless both legitimately match the search)
- Merge or confuse their data in any way

The Uniqueness Rule

A listing is UNIQUE based on the combination of:

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UNIQUE KEY = address + city + state + name

NOT just name alone. NOT just name + city. The FULL address is required for uniqueness.

Why this matters:

Name	Address	City	Same business?
Allure Hair Studio	123 Main St	Philadelphia, PA	Business A
Allure Hair Studio	456 Market St	Philadelphia, PA	Business B (DIFFERENT)
Allure Hair Studio	789 Broad St	Philadelphia, PA	Business C (DIFFERENT)
Allure Hair Salon	123 Main St	Philadelphia, PA	POSSIBLY same as A (same address, similar name — flag for review)
Allure Hair Studio	123 Main St	Atlanta, GA	Business D (DIFFERENT — different city)

Implementation Requirements

1. Database Constraint

SQL

```
-- Unique constraint on the combination, NOT on name alone
ALTER TABLE tour_guide_businesses
ADD CONSTRAINT unique_listing UNIQUE (name, address, city, state);

-- Same for the main businesses table
ALTER TABLE businesses
ADD CONSTRAINT unique_business UNIQUE (name, address, city, state);
```

2. Duplicate Detection (Soft Match)

When a new listing is being added (by seed script, owner claim, or community submission), run a soft-match check:

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```
IF exact match on (name + address + city + state) → REJECT as duplicate
IF fuzzy match on name (>85% similarity) AND same address → FLAG for manual rev.
IF exact name match but DIFFERENT address in same city → ALLOW (they're different)
IF similar name but DIFFERENT category/type → ALLOW (Apollo Pizza ≠ Apollo Theater)
```

3. Search & Display Rules

When a user searches "Allure" in Philadelphia:

- Show ALL listings matching "Allure" in Philadelphia
- Each gets its own card, its own pin, its own reviews
- Sort by relevance (exact match first, then partial)
- Show address on the card so users can distinguish between them

When a user searches "Apollo" in NYC:

- Show Apollo Theater (cultural_landmark) AND Apollo Pizza (business) as SEPARATE results
- The designation badge (Cultural Landmark vs. Business) helps users distinguish
- They are NOT linked, NOT grouped, NOT confused

4. Owner Claiming with Name Conflicts

If someone tries to claim "Allure Hair Studio" in Philadelphia:

- Show them ALL listings with that name in Philadelphia
- Ask them to confirm WHICH ONE is theirs by matching the address
- If their address doesn't match any existing listing, create a NEW listing (they're a 5th Allure!)
- Never auto-merge claims

5. Pin Display with Nearby Same-Name Businesses

If two "Allure" salons are within 2 blocks of each other:

- Show BOTH pins (don't collapse)
- When zoomed out, if pins overlap, show a cluster badge ("2 businesses")
- When user taps the cluster, expand to show both individually
- Each has its own card, reviews, and content — completely independent

The "Is This a Duplicate?" Decision Tree

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New listing submitted: "Allure Hair Studio, 123 Main St, Philadelphia PA"

Step 1: Exact match check

- Does (name + address + city + state) already exist?
- YES: Reject. "This listing already exists."
- NO: Continue.

Step 2: Same-address check

- Does this exact address already have a listing (any name)?
- YES: Flag for review. Could be a business that renamed, or a new tenant.
- NO: Continue.

Step 3: Same-name-same-city check

- Does this exact name exist elsewhere in this city?
- YES: ALLOW. It's a different location of a common name. Create as separate
- NO: Create normally.

Step 4: Fuzzy-name-same-address check

- Does a similar name (>85% match) exist at this address?

- YES: Flag for review. Might be a typo or slight rebrand.
- NO: Create normally.

Cultural Landmarks vs. Businesses with Similar Names

Additional rule: A `cultural_landmark` and a `business` should NEVER be confused even if they share a name or are nearby. The `primary_designation` field is part of the identity:

- "Apollo Theater" (`primary_designation: cultural_landmark`) $\neq$ "Apollo Pizza" (`primary_designation: business`)
- "Freedom" (a heritage site) $\neq$ "Freedom Barbershop" (a business)
- "King Records" (`cultural_landmark`) $\neq$ "King's Chicken" (business)

These should never appear in each other's "related" or "nearby" suggestions unless the user explicitly searches broadly.

VERIFICATION REQUEST

Please confirm you understand by answering:

1. If I seed 4 different "Allure Hair Studio" listings in Philadelphia with 4 different addresses, how many pins appear on the map?
2. If a user searches "Apollo" in NYC, what results appear and how are they distinguished?
3. If someone claims "Allure Hair Studio" but their address is 999 New St (not matching any existing listing), what happens?
4. What is the unique key that determines whether two listings are the same business?
5. Can "Apollo Pizza" at 100 W 125th St ever be merged with or linked to "Apollo Theater" at 253 W 125th St? Why or why not?